Fulfilling PM's Digital India Dream

The Chief Minister unambiguously realises that the Haryana government's e-learning scheme will definitely prove to be a milestone in fulfilling Prime Minister Sh. Narendra Modi's dream of Digital India. Undoubtedly, tablets and data are tools for students which will help them acquire skills of the 21st century and open new opportunities at national and international level.

In the long run it would spark the imagination of the youth as one might have seen in many countries youngsters developing apps which find multiple uses in our daily lives and it affords the youth to prove their mettle.

Personalised Adaptive Learning

In order to ward-off the digital divide among government school students, the state government undertook a novel initiative and came up with a sustainable strategy that could enable personalised learning for students at home even after schools reopened.

The government decided to provide tablets to students with pre-loaded PAL (Personalised Adaptive Learning) software. The Chief Minister set the vision for it and the Education Department evolved the App of its own kind. The essence of the tablet model has been that each student should have a separate tablet, for learning at their own pace, and the tablet can be used at home or at school in the presence of the teacher. The students has access to at-grade as well as remedial content in the form of videos, games and practice exercises.

Teachers have been provided internet-enabled tablets to assess students' progress and receive feedback. The tablets also have a mobile device management (MDM) system that provides security, prevents misuse and enables remote handling of each tablet. MDM allows for seamless and over-the-air installation and update of software the tablets from a centralised admin console. After the necessary budgetary approvals were in place and the programme design was finalised, identifying the most suitable PAL software at this scale was a challenge.

The government designed a comprehensive process for procurement: (1) qualifying stage to filter-out software without adaptability, (2) technical evaluation on PAL effectiveness using a framework, (3) pilot programme with the PAL solution to get proof of concept, and (4) organisational capability of the PAL provider. The government partnered with NCERT's Central Institute of Educational